student finance england
the student finance experts

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You need to write your Customer Reference Number on every document you send us.

Student Finance England
PO Box 210
Darlington
DL1 9HJ

www.gov.uk/studentfinance
0300 100 0607

Date: 5 March 2024

Customer Reference Number**: 32442858384**

Dear Mr Mayaki,

We've approved your Disabled Students' Allowance (DSA) 2023/24

We've received your Study Needs Assessment report and can now confirm what support you're entitled to. The following information shows what DSA you've been awarded and what you need to do next. We've also enclosed a helpful Frequently Asked Questions about your DSA.

Keep this letter because you'll need to refer to it again.

You must be registered on and attending your course to be entitled to support. If you leave or don't start your course you must let us know as soon as possible.

If you have any queries regarding your support please do not hesitate to contact us.

Yours Sincerely,

Student Finance England

We've also sent a copy of this letter to your Disability Adviser and Needs Assessor

Your DSA

Specialist Equipment Allowance

Item	Supplier	Contact Details	Quote Number	Amount you'll pay the supplier	Amount we'll pay the supplier
Equipment	Iansyst Ltd	01353 881 066 cop@iansyst.co.uk	411-942-049	£200.00	£1,408.00

Your next steps

1. You will need to contact the supplier(s) to arrange your support.
2. Pay the supplier £200.00 towards the cost of the agreed computer. All students are required to pay a contribution of £200.00 towards their agreed computer; we'll pay the rest of the computer cost.

The supplier will want to see a copy of this letter to confirm the agreement they will then invoice us directly for the agreed amount. If you've any issues with the equipment you should contact the supplier.

A breakdown of the items agreed in quote number (411-942-049) can be found in Appendix 1.

Insurance
Insurance is important and is included as a part of your equipment package from the date you receive your equipment. You must ensure you read the terms and conditions of the insurance when you receive your equipment.

DSA can't be used to meet the cost of replacement equipment when the original has been lost, stolen or damaged.

Non-Medical Helper's Allowance

Item	Supplier	Contact Details	Duration	Amount we'll pay the supplier
Assistive Technology Training	Amano Student Support	01822 600 060 dsa@amanotech.com	4 x 2 hour sessions	£108.80 (+ VAT) per session
Specialist Mentor (SM-MH)	UMO (University Mentoring Organisation)	020 3582 9730 info@umo.services	60 hours per year	£59.99 (+ VAT) per hour

Your next steps

1. You will need to contact the above supplier(s) to arrange the support
2. You'll receive the support at the arranged time and need to sign timesheets to confirm the support has been provided.

The provider will invoice us directly to cover the cost of the support.

General Allowance

Please note you'll need to pay the following support upfront. We'll be happy to reimburse you for any items agreed once we receive receipts.

Item	Amount available to you
Ink and Paper	Up to £120.00 per year

Your next steps

1. Purchase any items listed above that you require for your course
2. Submit your claim along with copies of receipts for the items.
3. We'll reimburse the amount directly to your bank account once the claim has been processed.

You can use this allowance for:

- ink and paper suitable for your printer

You can't use it for specialised paper or stationery such as photo paper, glossy paper, matt paper, brown paper, cardboard paper, refill pads, notebooks, post-its, wall planners, flipcharts, diaries or card. Ink pens and ink refill pens are also not covered.

Receipts must show the following information:

- Date
- Amount that has been paid
- Item description

If you applied for DSA online

1. Get a clear and readable digital copy of your receipts. You can take a photograph or scan to do this.
2. Go to www.gov.uk/student-finance-register-login
3. Sign in with your student finance login details.
4. Go to the DSA section of your account.
5. Upload your receipts and click submit.

If you are unable to provide evidence online or applied for DSA by paper

You can email a copy to us at dsa_team@slc.co.uk, or send it to us by post:

Student Finance England
PO Box 210
Darlington
DL1 9HJ

Please note, only items purchased after the date of agreement and before your course end date can be refunded. Claims must be submitted for reimbursement within one year of the purchase date.

The following is paid from your General Allowance but we'll pay the supplier directly.

Item	Supplier	Amount we pay to the supplier
Study Needs Assessment fee	Your Assessment Centre	£660.00 (+ VAT)

Appendix 1 – Breakdown of Specialist Equipment

Please find a breakdown of the equipment items agreed in quote number (411-942-049).

Item	Reference
Delivery Setup and Familiarisation in one timed appointment (Standard - 1.5 hours)	86586
DSA Multifunction Printer/Scanner	23478
Glean Notes for DSA Glean by Sonocent	235012
Laptop Carry Case (Briefcase/Rucksack/Slipcase - To be decided by student)	EQCASE001
Microsoft Office 365 Pro Plus Installation - English Version (free)	MSOPC
Present Pal v6	235004
Read&Write (includes AutoCorrect)	RWG-24
Scholarcy	22055
Software installation & configuration	1122
WKH Notebook	233750
Warranty	
Insurance	
Maintenance and Support	

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

How To Contact Us

Phone: 0300 100 0607

Post: Student Finance England, PO Box 210, Darlington, DL1 9HJ

Email: dsa_team@slc.co.uk
Please ensure you use the email address registered on your account and that you state your full name and customer reference number. This will help us to answer your query without any delays.

You can also visit our website at www.gov.uk/studentfinance for more information.

Maximum DSA Allowance

Academic Year 23/24
The maximum DSA allowance for all students, regardless of mode of study, is £26,291 which covers Equipment, Non Medical Help and General Allowance.

Academic Year 22/23
The maximum DSA allowance for all students, regardless of mode of study, is £25,575 which covers Equipment, Non Medical Help and General Allowance.

Academic Year 21/22
The maximum DSA allowance for all students, regardless of mode of study, is £25,000 which covers Equipment, Non Medical Help and General Allowance.

Academic Year 20/21

Undergraduate	**Equipment Allowance (per course)**	**Non Medical Helper Allowance (per year)**	**General Allowance (per year)**
	2020/21	**2020/21**	**2020/21**
Part Time 25%	£5,849	£5,815	£489
Part Time 50%		£11,629	£977
Part Time 60%		£13,955	£1,172
Part Time 75%		£17,443	£1,465
FULL TIME	£5,849	£23,258	£1,954

Postgraduate	**Equipment Allowance, Non Medical Helper Allowance, General Allowance and Travel**
2020/21	**£20,580**

These figures in these tables are the maximum amounts - most students get less.

Equipment

What if I feel I need additional equipment?
If you require equipment that hasn't been agreed as part of your DSA entitlement, you'll need to contact your Needs Assessor to discuss your requirements.

I would like to upgrade my equipment to a higher specification/different model, how do I do this?
If you want to upgrade your equipment you'll need to pay any extra costs for this. To upgrade, contact the supplier to discuss what equipment you would prefer. The supplier will tell you if this meets the minimum specification and if it will run your recommended software. They'll also advise on the extra costs for the upgrade. The supplier will then invoice us for the amount we've agreed to cover with your DSA and will then invoice you for the extra costs for the upgrade.

I would like to change the DSA approved equipment supplier, how do I do this?
It's possible to change the provider of your equipment. If you wish to do this, please email the DSA Team with your request to change provider before you contact the authorised supplier to process your order. Your email will need to include the following information:

- reason for changing provider
- name and contact details of new provider

Please note that we can only pay up to the amount agreed within this letter. You can find out the amount we'll pay by checking the 'Your DSA' section of this letter.

Can I purchase a computer from the internet or high street supplier?
If you want to purchase your own computer you need to email us for further information. Reimbursement can only be provided for a computer; all the remaining equipment and software must be purchased from the agreed supplier.

My equipment is faulty/not working properly, what do I do?
If you experience any issues with your equipment whilst it's under warranty, you'll need to contact your equipment supplier.

If you experience any issues with your equipment when it's no longer under warranty, you'll need to contact the DSA Team by email.

I have some questions about my equipment / I am not happy with the quality of my equipment, what do I do?
In the first instance you should contact your equipment supplier to discuss your queries/concerns. If this remains unresolved, you'll need to contact the DSA Team by email.

Non Medical Help

What should I expect from my non-medical help support?
A guidance document has been created and published online and this explains what you can expect from your non-medical help support: https://www.practitioners.slc.co.uk/exchange-blog/2022/january/your-disabled-students-allowance-funded-non-medical-help-nmh-support-what-can-you-expect/

What if I miss or need to cancel a non-medical helper support appointment?
Your provider can charge for any missed or cancelled appointments if you've not given reasonable notice (this is usually 24 hours but you should check this with your provider).

I feel I need additional or different non-medical helper support, who do I contact?
If you require additional non-medical helper support (not including assistive technology training) or feel different support is required, you'll need to contact your Needs Assessor to discuss your requirements.

I feel I need assistive technology training or need more than initially agreed, who do I contact?
If you require assistive technology training that hasn't been agreed as part of your DSA entitlement, you'll need to contact your Needs Assessor to discuss your requirements.

Can I change to another non medical help provider if they are unable to meet my needs?
If you wish to do this, please email the DSA Team with your request to change provider. Your email will need to include the following information:

- type of support you want to change (e.g. assistive technology training, mentor support, etc.)
- full explanation of why you want to change and why your current provider is not suitable/unable to meet your needs

Please note, SFE can only consider change of NMH provider requests if you are not satisfied with the service being provided and you have spoken with your provider to try to rectify any issues. A full explanation for your reasons must be provided. We cannot change your provider if you have not accessed/tried to access the support from your current agreed provider.

Also please be aware that if we agree to a change in provider, we will request new quotes from your Needs Assessor and write to you with the details of your new provider. You will not be permitted to choose your own provider.

Do I need to sign timesheets for the non-medical helper support I receive?
Your provider needs to provide signed timesheets when invoicing us as this will confirm you've received the support. You shouldn't sign any timesheets before you receive support.

Non Medical Help Framework – Registered Providers

On the 28th April 2016 a Non-Medical Help (NMH) Quality Assurance Framework was introduced. From that date all NMH providers must register in order to be considered to provide support. As an exception, any student who was already in receipt of a type of NMH support has been allowed to continue to use their NMH provider, and will be allowed to do so until the end of their course.

In addition, where students continue from an undergraduate course to a postgraduate course without a break and continue at the same Higher Education Provider, their current NMH provider can continue to provide support if they remain unregistered.

Where students break their study between postgraduate and undergraduate courses, or change their Higher Education Provider, new approved NMH providers must be used. As is the case now, all new types of support will only be agreed with an NMH provider who is approved.

Change of Circumstances

My circumstances have changed, what do I do?
If your circumstances change this may affect your support. For example, if you've changed university or college the supplier of your non-medical helpers support may need changing. You need to email the DSA Team advising of any changes so we can ensure that your correct entitlement is in place.

My medical condition has worsened/I have an additional medical condition, what do I do?
If you've a medical condition(s) that hasn't been taken into account during your Study Needs Assessment, or your medical condition worsens you need to send us a copy of your medical evidence.

Medical evidence for a new condition must confirm:

- a diagnosis of your condition
- your condition is long term (more than 12 months)
- how your condition has an adverse effect on your ability to carry out daily activities

Medical evidence for the worsening of a condition must confirm:

- how your condition has changed/worsened since your Study Needs Assessment
- that the change is permanent or long term (not temporary)

Once we receive acceptable medical evidence we'll write to you to confirm if you can attend a review at the Needs Assessment Centre where your previous assessment was carried out. Your Needs Assessor will make recommendations for any support you may need as a result of a new condition.

Do I need to apply every year for my DSA?
You only need to apply every academic year on a DSA full form for DSA if you:

- are a postgraduate student
- are a part-time student
- only get DSA funding (i.e. no tuition fees/maintenance loan etc.)

You don't need to provide medical evidence and ID every year if you're continuing on the same course at the same university or college.